

Sammy Abdella

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EDUCATION

Columbia University, New York, NY
B.S. Computer Science, GPA: 3.63/4.00

May 2027

SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, C++, JavaScript, SQL, HTML/CSS

Backend: Django, REST APIs, OAuth2/JWT

Data/Infra: PostgreSQL, Docker, Kubernetes

ML: PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, Large Language Models (LLMs)

EXPERIENCE

Web Developer Intern, Columbia College Information Technology - New York, NY May 2025 - Present

- Migrated 43 Columbia departmental websites from Drupal 7 to Drupal 10; wrote migration scripts, refactored custom modules, and ran regression tests; improved average page load times by ~35% and eliminated 100% of deprecated production modules.
- Integrated a Django, PostgreSQL, and REST API backend with a new Columbia admissions website; scaled to 50,000+ applicants per cycle, cut form submission errors by ~40%, and reduced manual data correction work by ~50%.

Research Assistant, Columbia University AI Lab - New York, NY

Jan 2025 - Sep 2025

- Developed gAyl, an AI tool for LGBTQ+ suicide prevention; designed six model-based safety benchmarks and achieved <15% false-negative rate on unsafe-response detection across 1,000+ high-risk prompts.
- Trained LLM-based classifiers (PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers) to automate safety evaluation, reducing manual benchmarking time by ~95%.
- **Publication (co-author | 2025 | dataset):** *Evaluating Trust and Inclusivity: A Machine-Driven Benchmark for Large Language Model Chatbots in LGBTQ+ Suicide Prevention: Data*. DOI: 10.7916/z6vc-d867.

Backend Software Developer Intern, Zitouna Bank - Remote

Jan 2024 - May 2024

- Engineered REST APIs using Python/Django to cut response times by 30% and boost transaction throughput by 25%.
- Partnered with database teams to tune PostgreSQL for real-time, high-volume financial data; reduced p95 query latency by ~35%.
- Ensured backend infrastructure aligned with security standards and financial regulations, resulting in a 100% compliance rate during audits.

Freelance Software Developer, Fiverr - Remote

Nov 2021 - Sep 2025

- Delivered 50+ client projects spanning web app customization, API integrations, and performance optimization; \$10,000+ total earnings.